

PRO-RED UNIT GETS BID

Link to Civil Rights Congress Backed by Party Chiefs

An organization calling itself the National Non-Partisan Committee to Defend the Rights of the Twelve Communist Leaders, 23 West Twenty-sixth Street, announced yesterday that it had been invited to become part of the Civil Rights Congress. The congress was listed as a subversive organization by the United States Attorney General on Dec. 4, 1947.

Harold Christoffel is executive director of the committee. William L. Patterson is executive secretary of the congress. Mr. Christoffel was convicted of perjury in denying that he was a member of the Communist party when he led the strike of a Communist-dominated United Automobile Workers local at the Allis-Chalmers plant in 1941; this was during the course of the Stalin-Hitler Pact, when Communists promoted defense plant strikes. The conviction was dismissed by the United States Supreme Court on technical grounds on June 27, 1949.

The Christoffel committee, of which Arnold Johnson is secretary, was organized to build public opinion in favor of the Politburo of the American Communist party, eleven members of which are appealing their conviction of teaching and advocating the overthrow of the government by force and violence. Mr. Johnson said Communist leaders had urged the absorption of the Christoffel committee by the Civil Rights Congress.